THE GREAT SAND SEA



GUILD

Created by Preston Garland

The Great Sand Sea

A daring trek across the great desert of Anauroch goes astray as the group of adventures hired to guard a merchant caravan are swept up in a fierce sand storm and lost in the endless sands. In their journey to find shelter from the blistering heat, they stumble across a large, sandstone pyramid, uncovered by the storm. They will have to dare this ancient tomb and the dangers within to find their way out of the unforgiving great sand sea.

Introductions

This adventure is a one-shot adventure for a group of level 3 adventurers. This adventure starts out with the players having already accepted the job as caravan guards for the gnome Banli and set out into the desert.

Setting Out

Read the below to introduce the setting to the players:

> Having found yourself in the small trading output of Hartvale on the edge of the Anauroch desert, also known as the Great Sand Sea, you met an opportunistic Gnome merchant Banli looking for guards to escort his caravan across the vast desert, as he searches for a much-sought route to the valuable markets of the east. The guards he hired were offered 100gp each, upon arrival on the eastern side of the desert.
>
> You set out into the desert three days ago, laden with supplies. As the sun sets on the endless dunes, Banli directs the caravan to an outcrop of rocks, in the shadow of which you make camp for the night.

As they set up camp for the night, Banli, the leader of this caravan, ask his new guards about themselves. What brought them to Hartvale? Why did they take the job to guard his daring expedition across the desert?

If they are unsure, you may provide some examples. They may have:

- Worked for (or fought against) the lizardfolk in Najara, while hunting down some bothersome monsters in the swamps
- Sought out the training/knowledge of the reclusive elves of Evereska, but left dejected after being bruskly turned away
- Been trying to escape debt collectors that finally caught up with them in Hartvale

If the conversation turns toward Banli and his background, reference the **Banli** section on the Background/Lore page.

Once the conversation falters, Banli heads to his tent to sleep and he encourages the rest of his guards to do the same. The caravan has a long way to go tomorrow. After they set a watch, of course. He is paying them for something, after all.

Bedine Night Raid

The caravan stops for the night in the shadow of rocky outcrop in the desert. During the night, a group of **Bedine Scouts** (1 more than the number of players) attack the camp. Ask the players if they are keeping watch and let them assign 2 hour shifts through the night. Roll a d4, the outcome of which will determine during which shift the Bedine attack.

The scouts will surprise the party members that are asleep. Have the person on watch make a DC 12 Perception check. On a success, they hear odd sounds out in the dunes. On an 18 or higher, they spot the raiders crouched behind a dune preparing to loose a flight of arrows at the camp. If they fail, they are surprised as well.

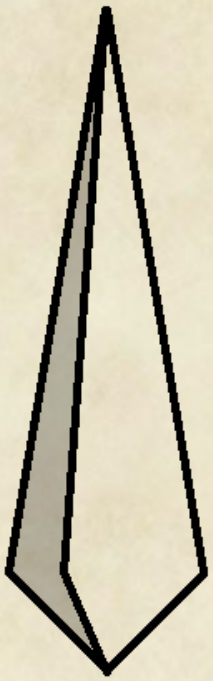
The Bedine scouts are zealots, fanatical in the defense of their ancient homelands. They will fight to the death to drive out the intruders. If captured, will try to end their own life before speaking. They have advantage in skill contests to be persuaded or intimidated and on saving throws against being charmed or frightened.

Banli wakes to the sound of fighting, but hides in his tent until the sounds of battle have died down.

Developments

If the players search the corpses of the scouts, each one carries a scimitar, a longbow, a quiver of arrows, and a small pack of supplies with food and water, but no other valuables. Have the searching player(s) make a DC 10 investigation check. On a success, they notice under the sleeves of their flowing, desert robes, the same strange, obelisk symbol is tattooed on the upper part of the left arm of each scout.

The Obelisk



Sand Storm

The following day, a sandstorm hits the party, separating them from the caravan and stranding them in the desert with their supplies and transportation ruined.

The party returns to sleep after the battle and the rest of the night passes uneventfully. Banli, undeterred by the nights events, is eager to set off again next morning. As the sun approaches its zenith, have the party make a DC 14 Perception check. Any who succeed notice a large, dark cloud on the southern horizon. The storm approaches quickly, becoming a massive, dark wall of sand and wind. Any player that did not notice initially (and was not warned by their comrades) hears the rising roar of the wind and looks up to see the approaching storm less than 100 meters way. The party has a few seconds to react and decide what they will do before the storm wall hits.

Skill Challenge: Enduring the sand storm is a skill challenge. The skill challenge is in two phases, in which the party is first caught in the sand storm and, once it is over, lost in the great desert. The characters must make a series of skill checks in order to survive the storm and navigate the desert. The skill challenge has the follow stipulations:

- A character may only use skills in which they are proficient
- Each skill may only only be used once (per character)
- The player must provide an reasonable description of how they will use the skill to overcome the problem

After a certain number of successes, they will locate a lone pyramid in the sands, uncovered by the recent storm. Failures will accumulate deterimental affects, even causing the party to become split up in the storm and suffer exhaustion in the desert (to prevent a downward spiral, you may choose to have the skill challenge checks not be affected by exhaustion). The default difficulty for checks in the skill challenge is **DC 13**, but should be adjusted based on how well the character justifies their use of the skill in the given situation.

Inspired by Matt Colville's video on skill challenges.

Ant Lion Trap (Optional)

An **Giant Ant Lion** has laid a trap out in the dunes. The pit it uses to catch its prey lies in the trough between two large dunes and is barely noticable in the constant up and down pattern required when walking through the desert.

Run after the 3rd failure in 'Lost in the Desert', as the party rushes to the mirage oasis. Ask the character leading the party to make a DC 15 Perception check. On a failure, they stumble on shifting sand at the edge of a shallow pit, 30ft in diameter. Have them make a DC 15 Dexterity Saving Throw. On a success, they manage to catch themselves at the edge and back away from the loose sand surrounding the edge of the pit. On a failure, they fall into the pit, sliding 10 feet towards the center of the pit and landing prone. The **Giant Ant Lion** notices if a creature moves the sand around its pit, even if it succeeds on the Dexterity Saving Throw and attacks, going first for the creature that disturbed the sand.

Success/Failures Chart

Sandstorm

Successes Effect

3	The party finds cover from the storm and waits it out

Failures Effect

1	Each character makes Con Sav. 12: On fail, they take 1d8 bludgeoning damage
2	Group is separated by storm

- Storm ends after three successes or two failures; completing the *Lost in the Desert* portion requires one additional success if the storm is failed
- All of the caravan's supplies have been lost in the aftermath of storm, ruined or swept away in the confusion

Lost in the Desert

Successes Effect

1	None
(2)	Reunite with lost group members
2(3)	Stumble upon small oasis (party can remove one level of exhaustion and also short rest in shade
3(4)	Locate pyramid

- Parentheses are only for if the party failed twice during the sand storm portion of the skill check
- The oasis is tiny and refills very slowly. The water cannot sustain a group indefinitely

Failures Effect

1	None
2	Each character makes Con Sav. DC 10: On a failure, they gain 1 level of exhaustion
3	A character spots an oasis, but upon approaching realize it is a mirage
4	Wander all day, night falls. Players cannot rest well enough for a long rest due to the extreme cold
5	Each character makes Con Sav. DC 15: On a failure, they gain 1 level of exhaustion
6	Each character makes Con Sav. DC 20: On a failure, they gain 1 level of exhaustion. If a character fail by 10 or more, they gain 2 level of exhaustion

- If the party hits 6 failures, move on to the pyramid section, with the party much worse for wear.
- Feel free to replace a failure outcome with a combat encounter instead. A **Giant Ant Lion** in its nest, which appears as an innocuous pit of sand, waits patiently for fresh prey to wander by.
- Banli may be separated from the party by the storm or can remain with the party afterward. He is a gnome **commoner** and will flee or hide from any combats that occur. Separating the party from Banli provides fewer things to manage and should increase the feeling of being lost in the desert, so this is recommended.

The Pyramid

As the party crests a particularly large dune, they see the golden peak of a pyramid rise in the distance. Read them the below:

> A weathered pyramid of yellow sandstone appears in the distance. As you approach, the massive structure towers above you. The stone is rough from weathering, but still maintains an unbroken slope up to the top.
>
> At the base, a single passage, flanked by the broken legs of two long destroy statues, disappears into darkness.

If the players do a circuit around the pyramid they will find the same slopes of weathered sandstone running of each side. There is no other apparent entrance except this front passage

1. Entrance

The entrance hall was an area meant for visitors and displays art showing the great deeds of the king entombed here.

> This appears to be a small memorial chamber, dedicated to whoever was interred here. Four pedestals hold 4 richly ornamented vases and intricate murals adorn the walls. A pair of similiarly carved doors sit on the far side of the room.

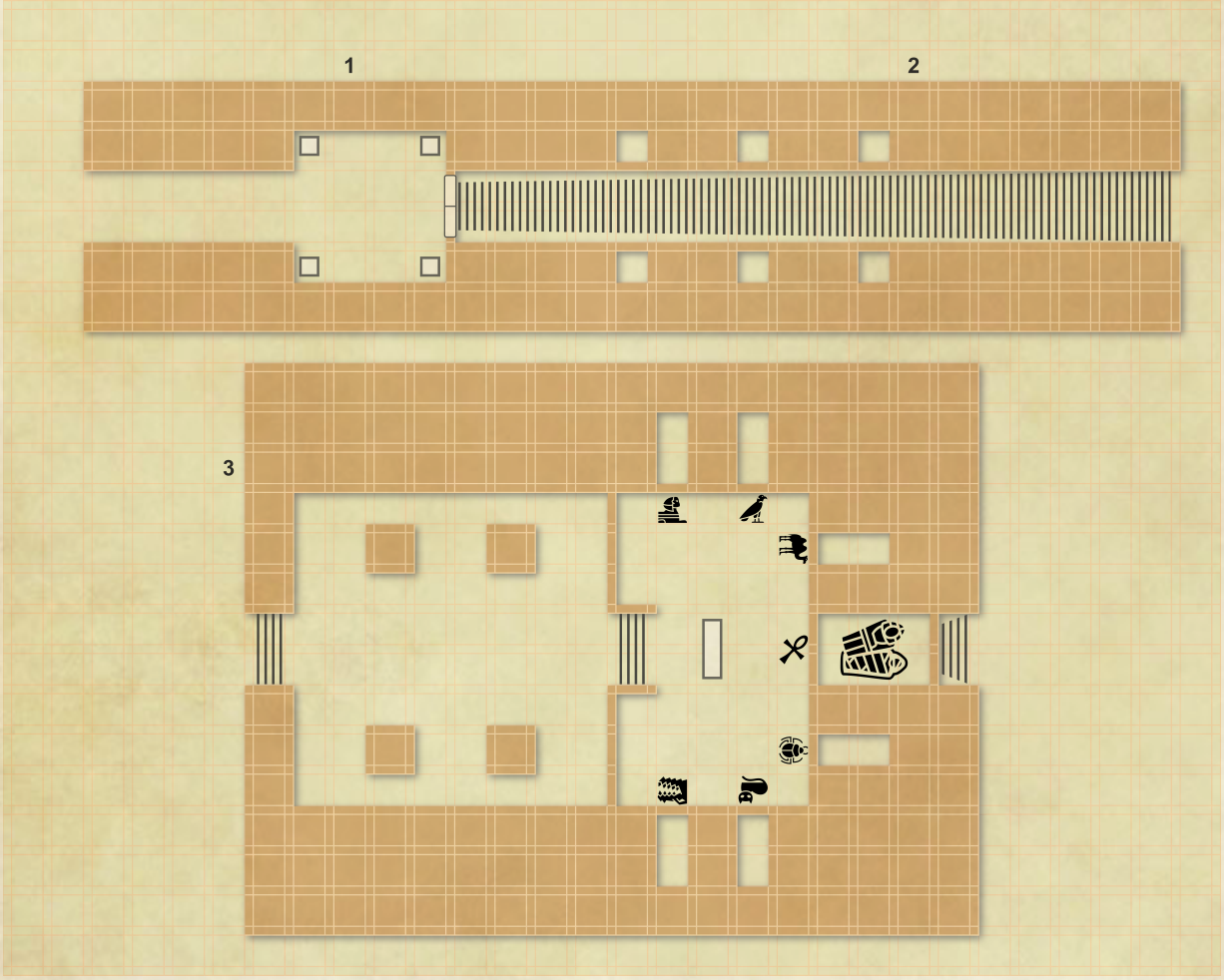
If the someone inspects the murals, there are four, three on the side walls and the last on the ornate door itself

Murals

1	A group of hunched bipedal canines pulling a large stone up scaffolding, under the eye of a humaniod taskmaster with shimmering skin
2	A shimmering humaniod figure framed by sunburst sits on a throne amongst bowing masses
3	The shimmering figure fights in battle against horde of abstracted black-colored creatures with glowing eyes and horns
4	(On doors) The shimmering figure stand with several attendents in front of a glowing obelisk, while 15 faint symbols sit in the sky above

After describing the mural on the doors, show the *arc of symbols* from the next page to the players. The vases, if inspected, depict much adstract versions of the murals on the walls.

The doors are not locked, but stuck from their long disuse. A character must succeed on a DC10 Strength check to pry the doors open, the stone doors grating against the stone of the floor and ceiling as they swing open.



Full size map art available here.



Full size arc of symbols art available here.

2. Stairs

Behind the doors is a long staircase, ascending upwards into the interior of the pyarmid. Hidden, empty alcoves sit behind false wall panels. They can be spotted with DC 15 Perception check, only while a character is within 10 ft.

Trap. 10ft from the top, one of the stairs is a hidden pressure plate. A characters must make a DC 20 Perception check (DC 15 if they are actively watching for traps on the stairs themselves) in order to spot the trapped stair. When a creature steps on the stair, it depresses with a audible click and triggers a **Rolling Sphere** to drop from the ceiling onto the very top of the stairs and begin to roll down. If unimpeded, it rolls all the way down the stairs and embeds in hallway connecting the Entrance to the outside, causing a minor collapse, as debris fills in the spaces around the sphere and blocks the exit entirely.

Allow each character to take one turn to attempt to avoid or stop the sphere before it rolls down the hallway and hits them. Any character struck by the sphere must make a DC 15 Dexterity Saving thrown, taking 16 (3d10) bludgeoning damage on a failure or half as much on a success. They may also attempt to dodge the ball by:

- Returning to the Entrance room and pressing up against one of the side walls
- Pressing themselves into one of the alcoves along the side of the wall. Each alcove can only hold one person and if the fake wall blocking the alcove was not broken before, it will take an action to break open
- Diving into the small, corner space of the wall where the sphere does not fully fill the rectangular hallway. Creatures attempting this must make a DC 10 Dexterity check, follwed by a DC 15 Constitution Saving throw (DC 10 for Small sized creatures) as the sphere rolls over their huddled form. If a creatures failed the Dexterity check, they are hit by the sphere taking full damage. A creature succeeding on the Dex check but failing the Con Save takes half of the sphere's damage.

3. Slave Burial Chamber

This chamber is where the slaves of the dead king were put to rest, ready to serve in the afterlife and provide the initial protection for the secrets of this tomb.

> The stairway opens into a large chamber lined with sandstone pillars supporting a high ceiling. At the other end sits a simple, white stone sarcophagus on an elevated platform.

Once the party ventures further into the room, they notice the walls on the elevated platform, surrounding the sarcophagus, have seven murals on them. These feature a Sphinx, Bird, Camel, Ankh, Scarab, Cat, and Crocodile. While these appear directly on the wall, they are depicted on the floors of the map on the previous page for ease of use.

The walls holding each symbol are actually thin plaster, behind which rests 6 **Gnoll Witherlings** and an undead **Gnoll Pack Lord** in simple sarcophagi. The **Gnoll Pack Lord** reside in the largest central chamber, behind the mural of an Ankh. These are the former slaves of the ruler laid to rest in this pyramid. They rise from their rest and burst from the walls if the central sarcophagus is disturbed.

Puzzle. Once the Gnolls are defeated, the party is free to look around the entire room at ease.

The stone sarcophagus is empty, with flat, white stone covering the sides and bottom. The only notably elements are seven indented squares, each displaying an inverted picture matching the murals on the walls. Ivory statuettes resting in the slave tombs can be placed here to trigger the bottom to slide aside, revealing a narrow staircase downward. Alternately, the characters can make a Strength check DC 20 to remove the stone bottom, revealing the staircase.

Slave Sarcophagi. If investigated after the battle, the slave sarcophagi each contains an ivory statuette (50gp) with top and the base matching the symbol on the wall outside each tomb. Placing each in their repective places inside the central stone sarcophagus will open the secret door.

Gnoll Pack Lord's Burial Chamber. The back wall of the is another fake wall, which can be discovered by a creatures that makes a DC 15 perception check from within 10ft. Alternately, any attack against the wall will cause an obvious, unnatural dent. Behind is a tunnel leading to area 6 on the next map and an alternate escape route from the pyramid.

Alternative Back Wall (Optional)

If you want to make it more likely that the players find this alternative route out of the pyramid, you can instead describe to anyone that enters this burial chamber an indent in the shape of an ankh in the back wall, identical to the one that appears in the The Obelisk Room later on. Players that remember this indent may decide to come back here once they obtain the Ankh from the Pharaoh's Tomb. Placing the Ankh in the indent will cause the wall to shift aside, revealing the passage to area 6.

4. Pharaoh's Tomb

This is the tomb of the ancient king of the long forgotten kingdom that used to exist in the Anauroch and built this pyramid. Inside rest the king along with two of his elite personal guard (you can increase this to four guards arrayed around the throne if you want to up the challenge. To reduce the difficulty for parties having a rough time, you may remove the guard's multiattack ability).

> The narrow stair opens onto a raised floor overlooking an ornate burial chamber room. The room is lined with four pedestals bearing various jewelry and ornaments. Three pillars of different heights rise throughout the room, each affixed with multiple mirrors. The rooms appears unfinished, as two wooden beams appear to support a portion of the ceiling on the north side of the room. In the center of the room sits an unmoving figure in a sandstone throne on a small dias, flanked by two kneeling figures.

A **Spawn of Kyuss** sits in the thone, flanked by two **Mummified Royal Guards**. Once a character descends the stairs and steps into the main burial chamber, the spawn and his guards awaken and attack the party. The spawn is not intellegent enough to negotiate and fights to the death. The spawn's body is covered in skittering, shifting scarab beetles (these beetles function identically to the Burrowing Worms from the Spawn of Kyuss creature description).

When reduced to 0 hit points, if it regenerates, the **Spawn of Kyuss** will not immediately rise again. Instead, it will play dead, lying in wait. If the characters activate the Obelisk, it will try to follow them and escape into the city to spread its infection (see **Conclusion: Cormyr** on the following page). Characters that investigate the body of the spawn notice that scarab beetles continue to skitter across its body.

Any detect magic used on the room will reveal that the whole is surrounded in faint divination magic (which is the spell of Life Sense that causes the king and his guard to awaken when a creature enters the room). It will also detect that one of the items on the pedestals, a large, golden Ankh, gives off a faint sense of divination and conjuration magic. This is the key to the teleportation circle in the Obelisk Room.

Developments

Wooden Scaffolding. The two wooden struts support a sandstone block in the ceiling. But the struts are rotted (revealed on a DC 10 Investigation or Perception check) and, if broken, the sandstone block will fall and sunlight will shine in, hitting the mirrors on the north-east pillar and bouncing throughout the room, filling the room with sunlight. Each wooden strut has an AC of 8 and 6 HP. The block in the ceiling shifts ominously after the first strut is broken. Any creature standing directly below the falling block must make a DC 12 Dexerity Saving Thrown, taking 3d8 bludgeoning damage on a failure or half as much on a success

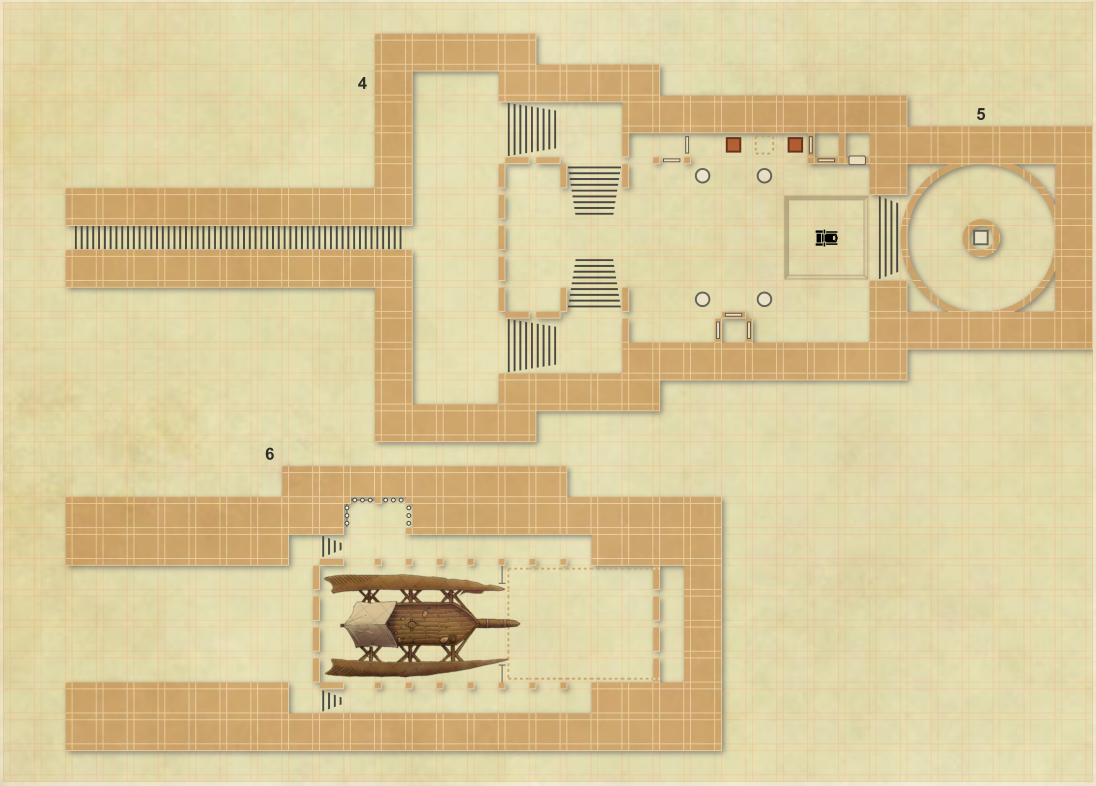
Treasure

Pedestals. The four pedestals hold each of the following:

- Golden Anhk (glows faintly with a strange magical light)
- Scarab Necklace - 100 gp
- Gold earrings featuring stylized eye - 150 gp
- Ornate Lapis Vase - 50 gp

North-East Storage Room. The small storage room in the north east of the chamber contains a chest with the below items:

- Alchemy Jug
- Cloaks of Fire Resistance (one for each character)
- 1000gp



Full size map art available here.

5. The Obelisk Room

Once the characters have defeated the king and his guard, they are free to explore the next room.

> Down a short staircase is another room dominanted by a floating white obelisk. The ground around the obelisk is sunk into the stone, create a depressed ring 10ft radius. On the ground just below the obelisk is a ring of stone depicting a variety of symbols.

Obelisk. When players investigate further, they will find the inner ring around the obelisk has the same symbols from the doors at the entrance. One of the symbols, the orb inside a circle(second from the left in the arc of symbols) glows with a faint, blue light. The base also has an indent in the shape of an ankh.

Puzzle. Obelisk is a portal. When activated, each creature inside the room is teleported across the continent to a similar portal in another place. Currently, the only active portal is the one in the city Arabel, in the nation of Cormyr (the symbol of an orb inside a circle). A player must insert the Golden Ankh from the previous room and then touch the glowing orb symbol to activate the portal. The orb symbol will flare brightly, then a faint sphere of light will appear around the ten-foot depressed ring surrounding the obelisk. After around 30 seconds, during which the sphere of light brightens to be nearly opaque and a low humming sound grows in intensity, any creatures or objects in the sphere of light are teleported to the exit portal. The Golden Ankh is left behind in its slot.

6. Secret Sand Skiff Dock

This is a secret dock for a sand skif. These magical boats were used to quickly traverse the desert terrain.

> This room appears to be a hangar of sorts, embedded in the side of the pyramid. A skiff sits in a narrow trench in the middle of the room. The trench leads down an incline clearly meant for launching the boat into the desert sands, but the exit has been blocked by large sandstone blocks.

Storage/Command Alcove. If players investigate the alcove to the north, they will find a row of 6 old, rusted glaives, long ruined food and water supplies, and an ankh-shaped indent in the wall.

Opening the Dock. The Golden Ankh from Area 5 can be placed in the ankh-shaped indent in the alcove. This will cause the sandstone blocks to drop out from in front of the exit. From there, players can easily use push poles on skif to push the boat to the ramp. The sand skif requires little experience or knowledge to steer and will magically propel itself across the sands at high speeds.

Conclusion

Cormyr

After the portal activates, the players are thrown into a pitch black room. Even for creatures with darkvision, it takes their eyes a few moments to adjust. One they do, they see a nearly identical room to the obelisk room, except floating in the center is an orb instead. The entrance has been bricked up, but is crumbling and can be broken through with effort.

Breaking through, they find themselves in an ancient, disused hovel. Venturing outside, they find a busy street, in the ghetto of some large Metropolis. A town cryer announces "Citizens of Arabel, the new king Cormyr has been crowned. May he reign long and bring prosperity to Cormyr!" at the corner before running on.

The Golden Anhk is nowhere to be found, having been left behind in the Obelisk Room.

Sand Skif Escape

The players race across the desert. They may head west back to Hartvale, or east to find Banli's passage. Either way, if the party was separated from Banli during the sandstorm, they will spot a half-buried cart with a figure moving around it on the horizon. Approaching, they find Banli attempting to salvage the supplies from this cart. He will ask for a lift back to Hartvale or to the eastern side of the desert with the remains of his wares.

Background/Lore

This is the background for the locations and peoples of this adventure. Feel free to ignore or cherry-pick anything as it suits your setting.

Banli

Character Background/Traits

- No surname, but says he is the son of Bandren if asked
- Ambitious and (perhaps overly) optimistic
- He is sure there is a way across the desert and he is the one to find it. If pressed, Banli will admit that other traders have tried to cross the desert before and disappeared without a trace. But Banli believe his expedition is different and will not fail.
- Left his father's thriving business in Hardbuckler (whose business produces delicate, complex items and implements, such as clocks, compasses, or spyglasses) to escape from under his father's shadow

Hartvale

Hartvale is a small trading outpost founded by the Gnomes of Hardbuckler as a waystation to trade with elves of Evereska and the Greycloak Hills. The occasional Lizardfolk or Yuan-ti seeking to trade will appear in the outpost as well, from the swamps of Najara in west.

Players with some knowledge of geography may asked why other routes around the desert would not work better. The Anauroch stretches into the far north, blending into The High Ice, a tundra of snow and ice that is might be more impassable than the desert itself. To the south, the Sunset and Stormhorn mountains block most travel.

The thin strip of land between these mountains and the Anauroch, known as the High Moors, looks suitable for easy travel on a map, but all native to this region know the land is overrun with hostile barbarian tribes and goblin bandits.

Bedine and D'tarig tribes

The Anauroch has several native tribes of mostly nomadic desert peoples. The D'tarig live on the outskirts of the desert, mostly along the south and south-east edge. While proud of their nomadic, desert life, they are mostly friendly to non-desert peoples and frequently engage in trade with communites near the deserts edge or traders that seek them out in the desert.

The more reclusive Bedine live in the inner desert. There are actually many more of them than the D'tarig, though few realize it, since they live much deeper in the desert and rebuff outsiders (often violently).

A fanatical splinter-sect of Bedine protect these lands (likely a contributor to past failures of Hartvale merchantes to find a rout across the desert). The original members of the sect pledged to protect the lands of the ancient civilization that build the pyramid, and the secret within. The modern members have long forgotten the location of the pyramid or the original reason for protecting this desert, but they still react with hostility to foreign intruders and will try to expel or kill them even against great odds.

Desert Temple

Buried in the sands of the Anauroch is the ancient tomb of a race of humanoids long lost to time. These ancients enslaved other, "lesser" races to build their cities, great momuments, and pyramids for their great kings.

When one of the monarchs of this civilization died, they were often buried deep within pyramids of massive sandstone. When a lord dies, his personal servants and most loyal guards commit suicide and are buried with their lord, to continue serving in the afterlife.

This pyramid was different. A temple to their gods and a conduit of some great ancient technology, one lord sought to hide and protect it from discovery by the outside world, for reasons unknown. He, his guards, and his servants were all emtombed alive and infused with powerful magic, to forever protect this secret from the world outside. Unbeknownst to the lord or his followers, a creeping infection entered the tomb carried with the lord. It infected him and now waits for a chance to escape and spread its corruption in the world again.

Even the common folk at the time of its contruction were lead to believe that it was merely another tomb, the existence of any alternate purpose erased from the records and public mind.

Portals

Long before even the inhabitants of the Anauroch built their great pyramid, an great system of portals connected the great cities and landmarks of the cosmos, allowing an unpresented level of globalization and trade across the nations of the world and even the planes.

As the portals were deactived or their keys lost during a mysterious calamity that struck the ancient world, most of these portals went dormant. As the memory of their use faded to myth and legend during future generations, the portal locations were lost to history. Any portal circles that still lie in existing cities are considered largely curiosities by the locals, who pay them little mind.

The other symbols above the Obelisk in the *arc of symbols* mural from page 4 all represent the locations of other portals across the planes of existence which are now inactive. These portals would each need to be traveled to indivdiually and reactivated in order to reconnect them to the network of portals.

Monster Descriptions

Bedine Scout

Medium humanoid (Human), Neutral Evil

Armor Class 13 (leather armor)
Hit Points 16 (3d8 + 3)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	13 (+1)	11 (+0)

Skills Nature +4, Perception +5, Stealth +6, Survival +5
Senses passive Perception 15
Languages any one language (usually Common)
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Keen Hearing and Sight. The scout has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing or sight.

Camouflage. The scout has advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks while in desert terrain.

Actions

Multiattack. The scout makes two melee attacks or two ranged attacks.

Scimitar. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Longbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, ranged 150/600 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage.

Giant Ant Lion

Large beast, unaligned

Armor Class 15 (natural armor)
Hit Points 52 (7d10 + 14)
Speed 40 ft., burrow 10ft

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)	1 (-5)	9 (-1)	3 (-4)

Senses blindsight 60 ft., passive Perception 9
Languages —
Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Actions

Multiattack. The ant lion makes three attacks: two with its claws and one with its sting.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) bludgeoning damage, and the target is grappled (escape DC 12). The scorpion has two claws, each of which can grapple only one target. While grappling a creature, the claw can only attack that creature.

Sting. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature that it has grappled in its claws. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage, and the target must make a DC 12 Constitution saving throw, taking 11 (2d10) poison damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

Lair Actions

On initiative count 20, Ant Lion can cause one of the following effects:

Sand shift. The ant lion shifts all the sand around it. All creatures within 30ft of the Ant Lion must make a DC 12 Strength Saving throw or is moved 15ft closer to the ant lion and knocked prone.

Throw sand. Ranged Weapon Attack: +4 to hit. Target is blinded until the end of its next turn.

Mummified Royal Guard

Medium undead, Lawful Evil

Armor Class 12 (natural armor)
Hit Points 24 (4d8 + 6)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	8 (-1)	14 (+2)	6 (-2)	8 (-1)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Wis +1
Senses darkvision 60 ft, passive Perception 9
Languages the languages it knew in life
Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, the royal guard has disadvantage on attack rolls, as well as on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Actions

Multiattack. The royal guard makes two melee attacks with its corrupted glaive.

Corrupted Glaive. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d10+3) slashing damage plus 3 (1d6) necrotic damage.

*Stats for the **Gnoll Pack Lord** can be found in the Monster Manual. Stats for the **Gnoll Withering** and **Spawn of Kyuss** found in Volo's Guide to Monsters.

Credits

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